A POCKET HOME PROJECT · GOA

Arjavam.

An abode in the *woods.*

A 2 BHK home that keeps the trees already on site, and settles in among them.

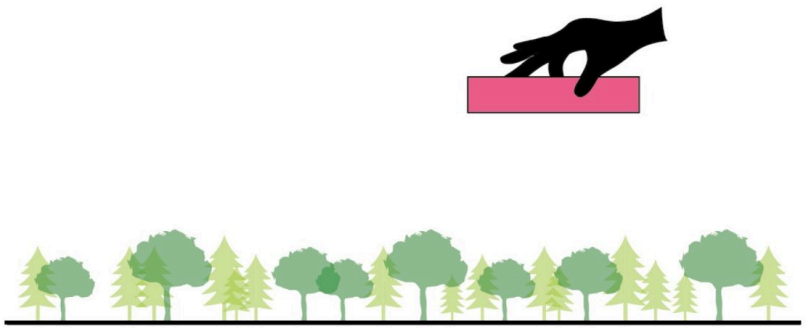
PLOT	BUILT-UP	TYPOLOGY
8K sq.ft	2,200 sq.ft	G+1

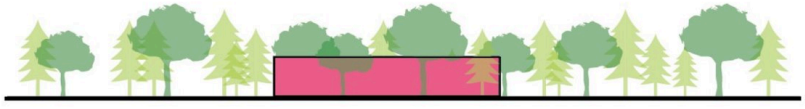


A simple abode *amongst the woods.*

True to its meaning, **Arjavam stands for simplicity.** The idea was never to clear a site and build on it. It was to set one quiet house down between the trees.







HOUSE IN THE WOODS

- **The woods come first**
  Mango, cashew, acacia and jackfruit trees were already here. The plan starts from them.
- **The house stays low**
  Long tiled roofs keep the form close to the ground, and the tree line stays higher than the living wing.
- **Life happens outdoors**
  Verandahs, a sit-out and a flower bed blur the edge between the rooms and the site.

AT A GLANCE

PLOT	BUILT-UP	CONFIGURATION	TYPOLOGY
8K sq.ft	2,200 sq.ft	2 BHK	G+1

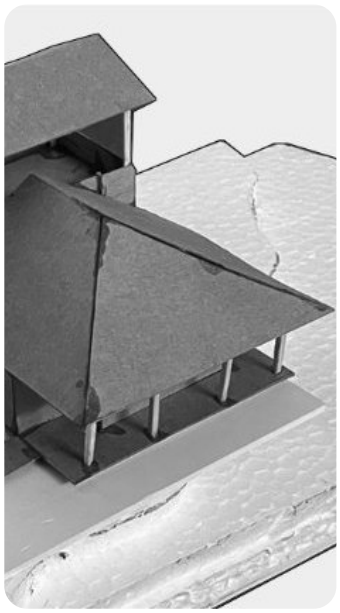
Built by *hand* first.

Physical models helped us understand **the scale of the built form with respect to the site context.**









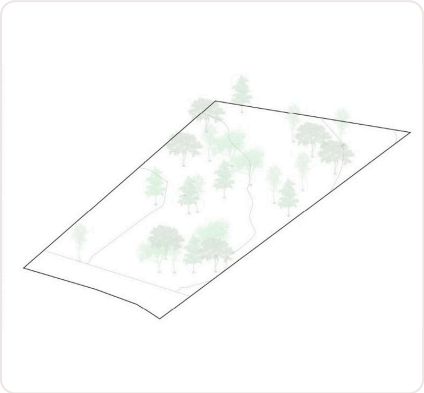
01–04 CARD MODELS: PLAN, SLOPE, VERANDAH AND ROOF

Why models

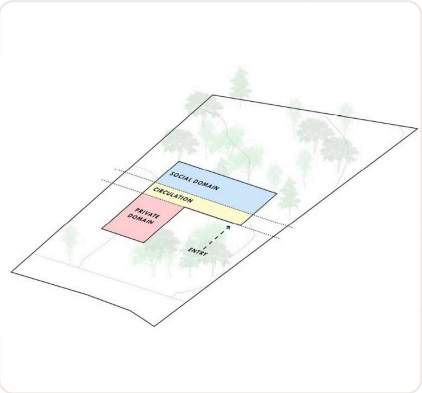
On a sloping, wooded site, a drawing can only tell you so much. A model shows how the roofs sit against the trees and the ground.

Eight *simple* moves.

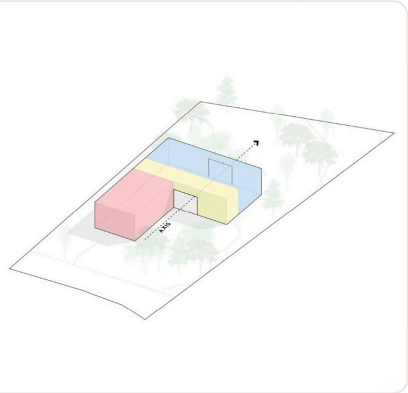
The form comes from a clear sequence, starting with what was already on the site.



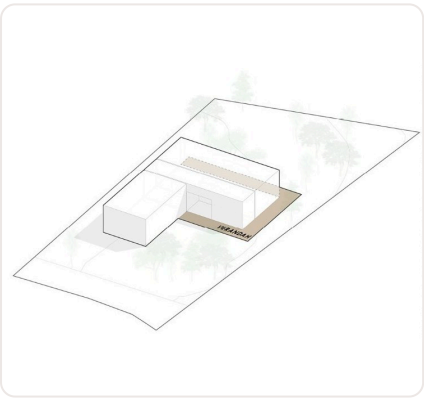
1 Site + existing trees
Start with what is there



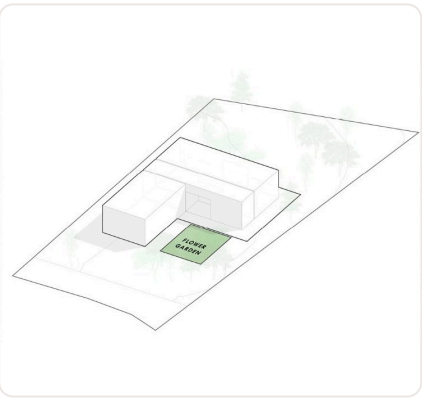
2 Domains
Social, circulation, private



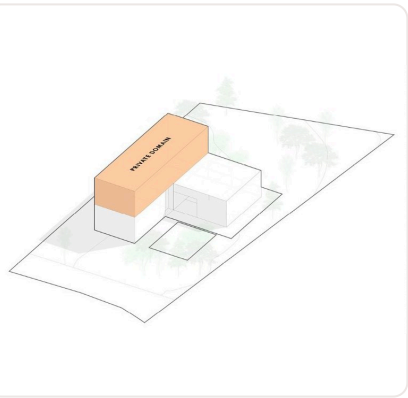
3 Axis
A line through the entry



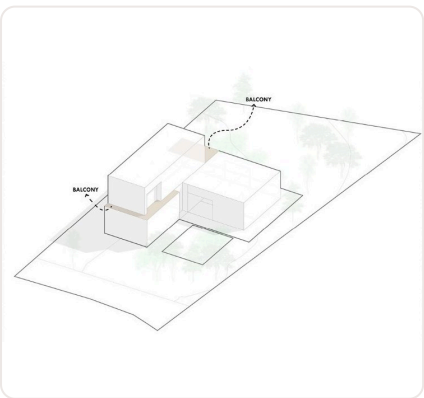
4 Verandah
A shaded edge



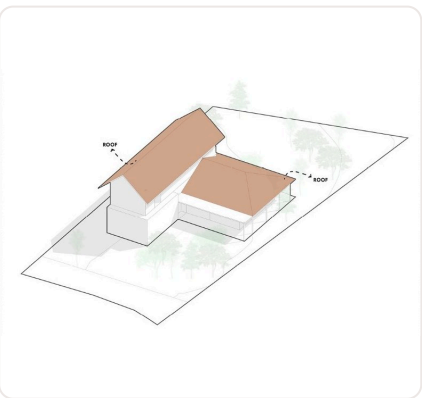
5 Flower garden
Green at the door



6 First floor
Private rooms lift up



7 Balconies
One at each end



8 Roof
Tiled slopes over all

Site first, *roof* last

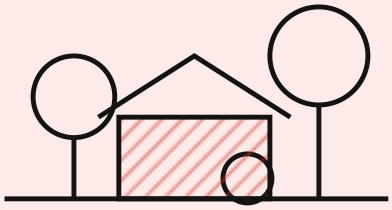
Your home. Your needs. Our *essentials.*

What you need is what you need. Here is how the eight essentials play out at Arjavam.

- **Light**
  Folding doors on both sides of the living room bring in daylight from two directions.
- **Wind**
  The same doors open fully, so air crosses the living and dining room from verandah to verandah.
- **Optimize**
  Social spaces, circulation and private rooms sit in three clear bands.
- **Storage**
  A full wardrobe wall, a wall-mounted puja unit and a built-in breakfast counter.
- **Layout**
  The mother's room is on the ground floor, with a ramp for wheelchair access.
- **Energy**
  Deep tiled roofs and verandahs shade the walls and keep the sun off the glass.
- **Plant**
  Existing trees stay, joined by a flower bed, a paved garden and farm terraces.
- **Maintenance**
  Laterite, plaster and Mangalore tile are simple materials that suit the climate.

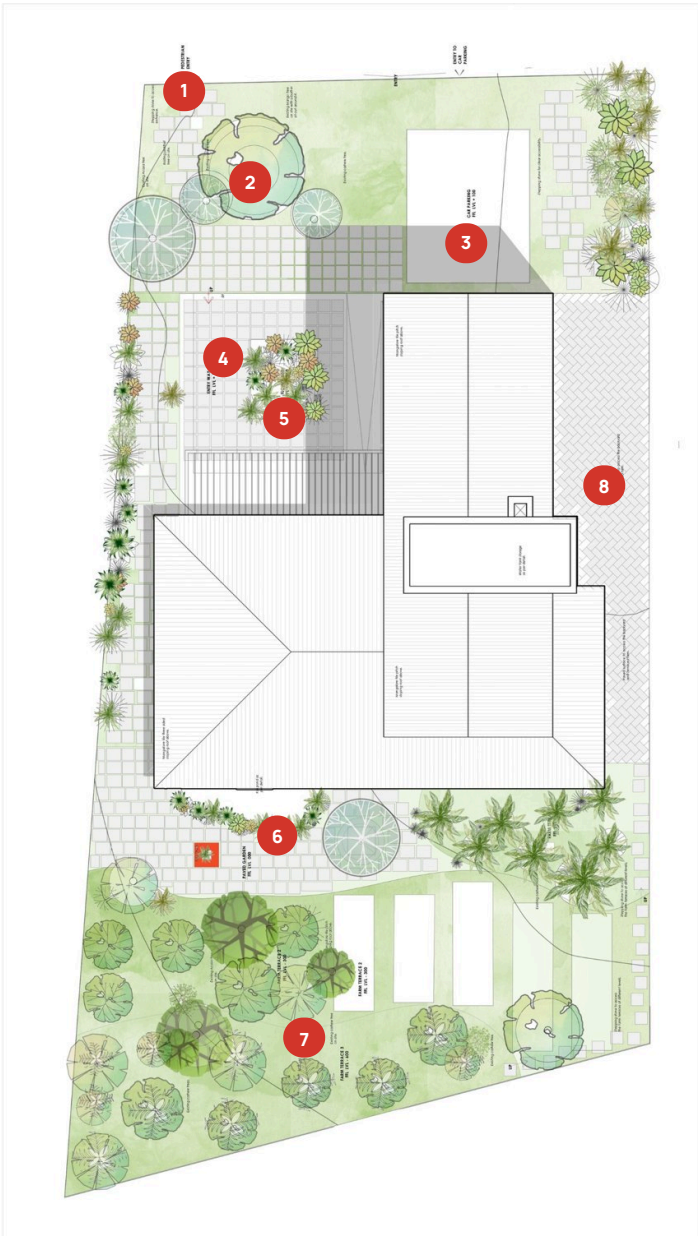
Every site has a *brief.*

Here it was written by the trees. The house was drawn to answer them, not to replace them.



Planned around the *trees.*

The levels follow the land, from the entry down to the farm terraces.



1 Pedestrian entry
Stepping stones to the door

2 Mango tree
Kept, with a built-in sit-out

3 Car parking
Level +100

4 Entry way
Level +150

5 Flower bed
Set into the entry way

6 Paved garden
Level 000, with a koi pond

7 Farm terraces
Step down to level -600

8 Side path
Paved, to the backyard

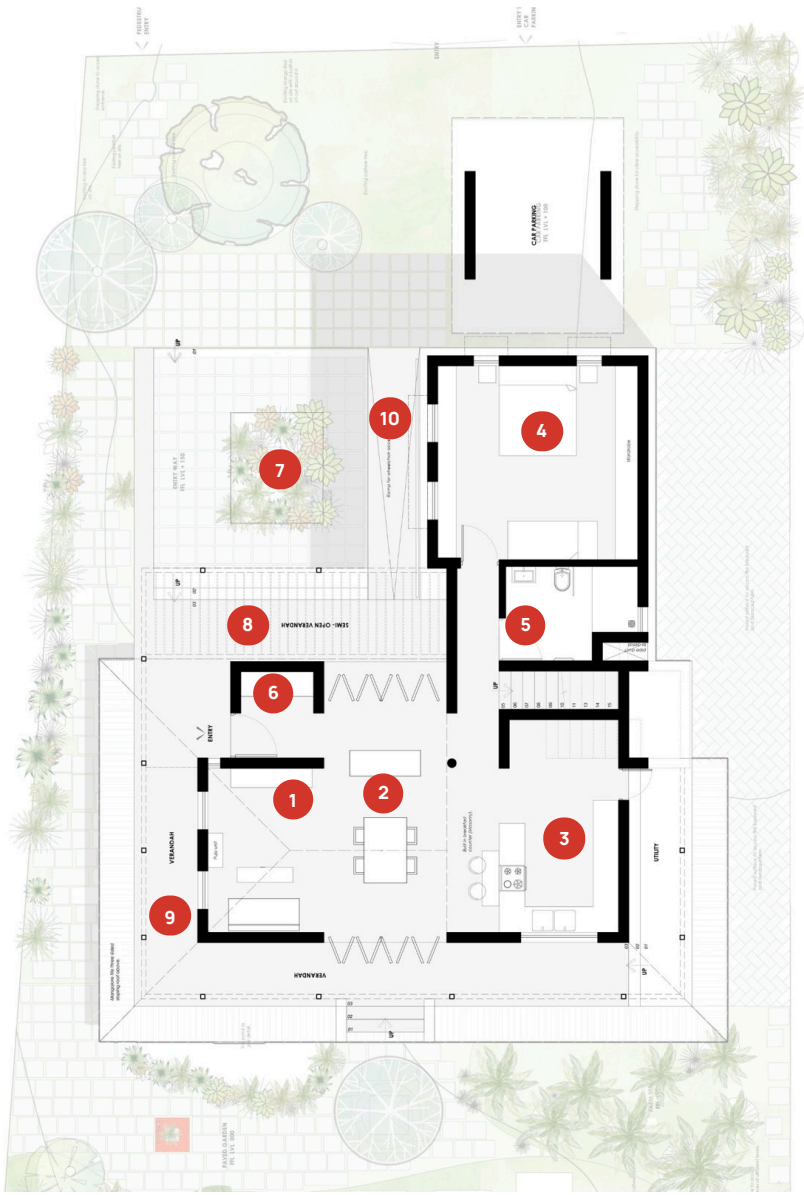
A seat under the mango

The existing mango tree stays, with a built-in sit-out around it.

EXISTING TREES · KOI POND

Rooms that open to the *garden.*

Living, dining and kitchen under one tiled roof, ringed by verandah.



1 **Living Room**
Folding doors on two sides

2 **Dining**
Beside the kitchen counter

3 **Kitchen**
Built-in breakfast counter

4 **Master Bedroom**
Mother's room, wardrobe wall

5 **Bathroom**
Attached to the bedroom

6 **Foyer**
Just inside the entry

7 **Flower Bed**
In the entry way

8 **Sit Out**
Semi-open verandah

9 **Verandah**
Wraps the living room

10 **Ramp**
For wheelchair access

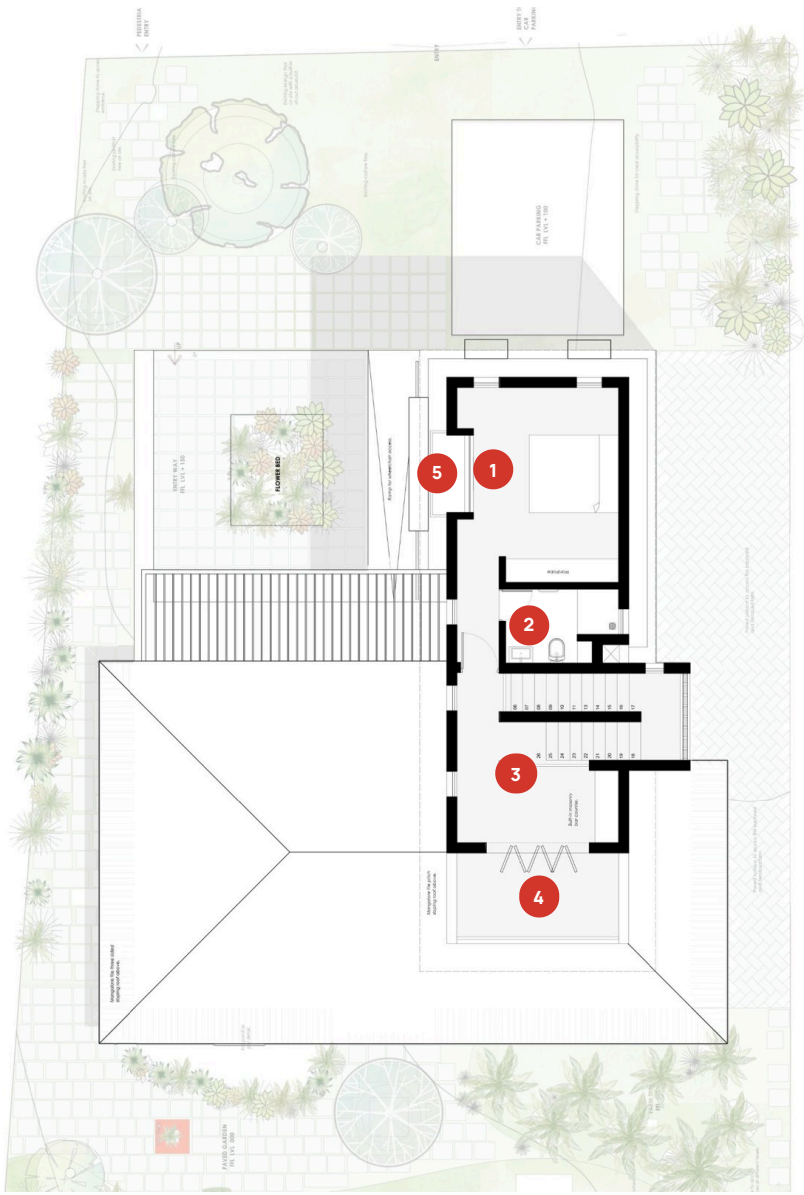
One step-free route

A ramp beside the bedroom wing gives wheelchair access from the entry way.

RAMP VERANDAHS

A quiet room *above* the trees.

A bedroom and a study, with a balcony at each end.



1 Bedroom
Wardrobe and attached bath

2 Bathroom
Attached to the bedroom

3 Study Area
Masonry bar counter

4 Balcony 1
Folding doors from the study

5 Balcony 2
Off the bedroom

Only what is needed

The first floor sits on the bedroom wing alone. The living wing keeps its single tiled roof.

2 BALCONIES

STUDY AREA



INSIDE · LIVING AND KITCHEN

One long room, *open* at both sides.

- **Living room**
  Tile-lined sloping ceiling, cane chairs, a stone dado and folding doors onto the garden.
- **Kitchen**
  A terracotta wall, a swing at the heart of the room and a breakfast counter for two.





INSIDE · BEDROOM AND STUDY

Calm rooms, with a *view* of the green.

- **Mother's bedroom**
  Tall timber windows, a full wardrobe wall and a day bed by the window.
- **Study area**
  Folding glass doors open onto the balcony, with a tile inlay set into the floor.



From drawing to *housewarming.*

Completed pictures from the housewarming. **Laterite below, plaster above and a tiled roof,** before the garden grows in.









We don't design.
We solve.

Arjavam began with the trees already on the site. Tell us what is on yours.

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